

271 Make a spiderweb catcher

15
MINS

What you need

- 3 medium-sized straight sticks
- 1 longer, thicker stick
- String or twine

Some people are afraid of spiders, but spiders help us by eating insect pests, and they are fascinating creatures to watch, especially when spinning intricate webs. You can safely get close to one with this web catcher.

1 Make a triangle shape out of the three sticks, using the string to tie them together at the corners. Ask a friend or adult to help hold the sticks in place so that tying the string becomes easier.

Wait for a spider

2 Attach the larger stick to the triangle, tying it into place with the string. You have now created a web catcher!

Fix securely

3 In late summer or early fall, push the long stick of the catcher into the ground, near some shrubbery where you have seen spiders. Check it each morning, and you may find that one of them has spun a web inside the triangle.



272 Identify spider webs

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Orb webs stretch across gaps, trapping flying insects. Radial webs have “trip-wire” strands that shake the web when touched. Large sheet webs trap crawling or flying bugs.

